

PURPOSE: For MSMS To Accept the Submission of Tuberculosis Blood Tests.

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**BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS
AND SCIENCE**

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS):

Tuberculosis- Tuberculosis (TB) is a contagious infection that usually attacks your lungs. Tuberculosis (TB) is caused by a bacterium called *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*.

Interferon-gamma release assays (IGRA)- An IGRA is a laboratory test that measures how strongly a person's immune system reacts to TB bacteria. An IGRA may also be called a TB Blood Test

TB Blood Test- also called an IGRA measures how the immune system reacts to the bacteria that cause TB.

FDA: United States Food and Drug Administration

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

Having the option to submit a TB blood test for the required documentation of a negative TB test would be easier, more efficient, and safer for students trying to apply/reapply to The Mississippi School of Mathematics and Science.

TB Blood Tests are more accurate than the skin test and do not require the patient to return to the doctor for a reading. The lab results can be sent directly to the patient which can then be sent to MSMS.

There are currently Two IGRAs approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) and are available in the United States:

QuantiFERON®-TB Gold In-Tube test (QFT-GIT)

T-SPOT® TB test (T-Spot)

“IGRAs are the preferred method of testing for TB infection. It should be the only test considered for:

People who have, or may have, received bacilli Calmette-Guérin (BCG). BCG is sometimes used in the U.S. as a treatment for some forms of cancer or as a vaccine for TB disease in some high-risk countries.

People who have a difficult time returning to have a skin test read.

IGRAs can be safely repeated.”

(msdh.ms.gov)

SECTION THREE (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On page 102 of the Student Handbook (PDF page 107) under the section “Student Affairs” the following would be changed to:

STUDENT AFFAIRS – RESIDENCE LIFE 102

5. Documentation that the student is TB free as evidenced by one of the following tests. (must be repeated annually. No student may move into the residence hall until these test results are on file):

- a) TB Skin Test
- b) Acid Fast Smear
- c) First Morning Sputum
- d) TB Blood Test

It is essential that parents immediately notify the residence hall of changes in medications, guardianship, insurance, address, telephone numbers and employment. Photo copies (front and back) of all medical and prescription cards should be attached to medical forms.

Note - Students who want to be treated at the Columbus Air Force Base Medical Clinic will need a legal document giving power of attorney to the school. Please check with the legal department at the local military base or call Columbus Air Force Base for details, and have the medical records transferred to Columbus. Parents are asked not to request MSMS personnel to make special trips to the CAFB for prescriptions which can be filled locally.